



Activision Bliz now exclusive on YT

Activision Blizzard and Google have partnered on all things streaming, even cloud streaming on Stadia. <https://digit.in/feb20-57>



Vampire Star system

A supposedly a rare event, a white dwarf in nova was found to be 'feeding on' a nearby brown dwarf. <https://digit.in/feb20-58>

BUYING ADVICE

A DREAM COME TRUE

Q Hello Agent001, I've been an avid reader of Digit magazine since the times of Chip India throwing tough competition to Digit. Since the time when Jasubhai Media group used to run the show. For many years, I've been reading Digit and enjoying the content so much. Digit has evolved to providing tech tips to reviewing high-end gadgets that a common man can only dream of.

I remember the days when we had to buy SKOAR! as a separate magazine and it used to be expensive. Reading Digit for all these years, I've been seeing so many builds and great components for gaming rigs.

Ever since then I've always dreamt to have an awesome gaming rig self-assembled. And now the time has come for it to turn to reality. After hours of googling, I've selected a few desired components and the specs seem to be amazing and they fit my requirement. I'm a casual gamer and would use this rig for 50% gaming and 50% video/image editing and some game building using Unity. This rig will be used for my work-related applications and for some sandboxing stuff but it'll mostly be gaming.

So the question here is I've chosen the Cooler Master HAF XB EVO for my case since this looks like a box that has good ventilation and looks decent. It houses a 2x USB 3.0 on the front panel & has 2x expansion slots for 3.5-inch and 2.5-inch drives. The mobo can be shelved in the second rack and has awesome cooling. The case has HAF and great ventilation. Only thing bothering is that it's a pretty old case and some vendors here are saying choose better.

Also, I'm wondering if my Sapphire 8GB RX 5700 will fit in it? Lastly, I'm not much of an RGB fan. So do you think the specs and everything I've chosen is a good fit?

Your tips & suggestions matter to me a lot so I hope you can help me build my dream PC. Also, I won't be

overclocking or water cooling but plan to use AIO for both graphics & CPU.

Specs-

- CPU - AMD Ryzen 7 R7 3700X
- Motherboard - GIGABYTE AORUS X570 Elite
- Graphics Card - Sapphire Radeon RX 5700 8GB
- Monitor - LG 22M38H 22-inch
- Memory - Corsair Vengeance LPX 16 GB 3200 mhz. CMK-16GX4M1E3200C16
- Memory - Corsair Vengeance LPX 8 GB 3200mhz. CMK-8GX4M1E3200C16
- HDD - Seagate IronWolf SATA 10Tb NAS ST10000VN0004
- Keyboard - Zebronic MAX PLUS
- Cabinet - Cooler Master HAF XB EVO
- SSD - Crucial P1 M.2 PCIe NVMe 500GB SSD CT500P1SSD8
- SSD - Lexar NS100 1Tb SSD

I plan to cool the CPU with an AIO



Cooler Master HAF XB EVO

(CM Master liquid 240M) & disassemble the RX5600 and add GPU bracket by NZXT and liquid cool the GPU with NZXT X52. Jam all these inside the HAF XB EVO. Is the Aorus Elite a better suited motherboard or are there any alternatives? I'm inclined to Aorus Elite for some reason but if there's a better option then let me know.

I don't plan to overclock and am definitely not into RGB so this case suits my style but your feedback would be very very helpful.

So please suggest & help me build my dream gaming rig :).

—Kiran Kumar



Hey Kiran, Your components are compatible with each other and the motherboard

along with the graphics card will easily fit into the Cooler Master HAF XB EVO. Secondly, the RAM modules, while they are of different capacities, the timings are the same so it shouldn't be a problem. The case has provision to fit one 240mm AIO in the front and one 120mm AIO in the rear, so you can't use the CM MasterLiquid 240M for the CPU and the NZXT X52 for the GPU. You will have to switch to a 120mm AIO for the GPU or the CPU. Under load the RX 5700 can consume about 230 Watts and the 3700X will eat up about 90 Watts. The heat dissipated will be of slightly lower but similar proportions. So it's better that you use a 240mm radiator for the GPU and a 120mm radiator for the CPU. You should be able to set up this configuration. The motherboard is fine, there's no problem with it and I don't see any resource conflicts given the number of devices you plan on connecting to it. Unless you're planning on utilising PCIe Gen 4.0, you really don't need an X570 motherboard. Instead, you can make do with a B450 board and save plenty of money. The B450 AORUS ELITE is a pretty good candidate and you can save about 10K by switching to it. 12 TB of storage certainly seems to be a lot. That 10 TB drive alone is going to cost a lot. Ideally you should calculate if you really do need that much space. A fast internet connection is often enough to quickly download your games from your platform of choice whenever you want. You can switch your monitor for a Dell P2417H which is an office monitor but it's got a better contrast ratio than the 22M38H, has better colour reproduction and has a flicker-free backlight. Also, 24-inches is sort of the sweet spot but it's entirely up to you. A higher refresh-rate alternative would be the ViewSonic XG2402. You haven't mentioned anything about your PSU and that's quite an important component. Something such as the Cooler Master MWE 650 or the Corsair CX650 should be more than sufficient. Lastly, you can switch to a larger case if you want. The vendors are probably asking you to switch because the XB EVO is a pretty old case and if there are any problems, you might not be able to get a replacement. That being said, passive components such as the case rarely need any maintenance.